

Benefits of a Strong Work Ethic

A nice, paid-for Florida vacation home is awesome, but it's not the biggest benefit you can gain from a strong work ethic. There are many more important advantages that will make you a better, more stable, more profitable person no matter what business you're in. First, a commitment to hard work builds patience. Reaching financial independence takes a long time. As we saw in chapter 3, the average millionaire hit the \$1 million mark at 49 years old. That means it took *decades* of slugging it out day after day for most of these families to hit their goal! The ability to work hard over a long period of time builds patience like nothing else will. It keeps you focused so you never lose sight of what you're striving toward.

Second, a good work ethic enables you to experience progress. Your work should take you a little closer to your ultimate goal every single day. Every paycheck, every 401(k) or other retirement account contribution, every promotion—they're all individual steps on your journey to financial independence. And little by little, as you check your progress and factor in your net worth, you're able to see that you are moving the needle.

Third, work gives you a sense of accomplishment. The old expression, "An honest day's work for an honest day's pay" means something. It feels good to get a paycheck for a job well done, doesn't it? Just imagine how you'll feel when your income comes solely from your investments that you've worked, saved, and sacrificed for. Although it seems far off now, those incremental investments from your paychecks add up over time. Never forget that you are building a perpetual stream of income in your investing accounts; every dollar you save and invest today will become part of your income later. Saving enough money to live on for the rest of your life is a huge deal, so be proud of every step you take toward that goal.

Fourth, good work continually builds your self-confidence. It shows us what we're capable of and reminds us what we've accomplished so far. Consider that for a minute. Think back to a job you had to perform or a big